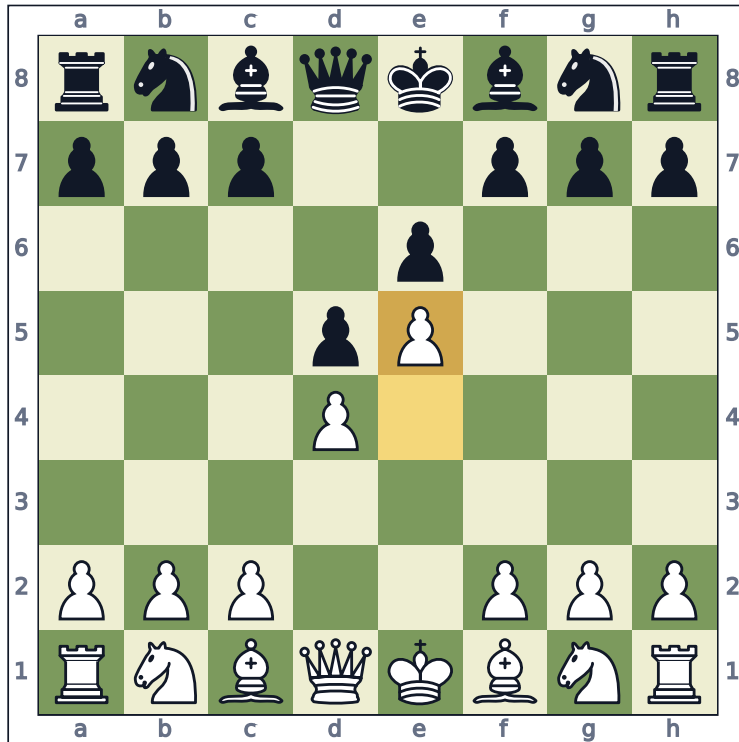


FRENCH DEFENSE

French Defense

ECO C02 | 22 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.20 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

C02 covers French Defense. Black builds a d5-e6 center and accepts a temporarily restricted c8 bishop in exchange for a clear attack on White's center. The diagram uses the featured line French Defense: Advance Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Use the space advantage, support the e5 chain when it exists, and develop before beginning a kingside attack.

BLACK'S GOALS

Challenge d4 with ...c5, attack e5 with ...f6 when sound, and solve the c8 bishop deliberately.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

...c5 is the basic break; ...f6 is the second. White often uses c3, f4-f5, or queenside play depending on the structure.

PIECE MAP

White's e5 pawn can gain space but needs support. Black's bad bishop often becomes active after ...b6 and ...Ba6 or after exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Both sides can misjudge the pawn chain: attack its base and calculate breaks rather than attacking where the chain is strongest. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d5, White pawn on e5, Black pawn on e6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

A sound, excellent defense with clear plans and rich counterplay, though cramped positions require patience.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C02 line

This section preserves all 22 names and defining routes assigned to C02 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 French Defense: Advance Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5

002 French Defense: Advance Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5

003 French Defense: Advance Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. c3

004 French Defense: Advance Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. c3 Nc6

005 French Defense: Advance Variation, Euwe Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. c3 Nc6 5. Nf3 Bd7

006 French Defense: Advance Variation, Extended Bishop Swap

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 Bd7

007 French Defense: Advance Variation, Frenkel Gambit

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. b4

008 French Defense: Advance Variation, Kupreichik Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. c3 Nc6 5. Be3

009 French Defense: Advance Variation, Lputian Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. c3 Nc6 5. Nf3 Qb6 6. a3 Nh6

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C02 line

This section preserves all 22 names and defining routes assigned to C02 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

010 French Defense: Advance Variation, Main Line

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. c3 Nc6 5. Nf3 Qb6 6. a3

011 French Defense: Advance Variation, Milner-Barry Gambit

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. c3 Nc6 5. Nf3 Qb6 6. Bd3

012 French Defense: Advance Variation, Milner-Barry Gambit, Hector Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. c3 Nc6 5. Nf3 Qb6 6. Bd3 cxd4 7. O-O

013 French Defense: Advance Variation, Milner-Barry Gambit, Hector Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. c3 Nc6 5. Nf3 Qb6 6. Bd3 cxd4 7. O-O Bd7 8. Re1

014 French Defense: Advance Variation, Milner-Barry Gambit, Main Line

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. c3 Nc6 5. Nf3 Qb6 6. Bd3 cxd4 7. cxd4 Bd7 8. O-O

015 French Defense: Advance Variation, Milner-Barry Gambit, Sørensen Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. c3 Nc6 5. Nf3 Qb6 6. Bd3 cxd4 7. cxd4 Bd7 8. O-O Nxd4 9. Ng5

016 French Defense: Advance Variation, Nimzowitsch Attack

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. Qg4

017 French Defense: Advance Variation, Nimzowitsch Gambit

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. Qg4 cxd4 5. Nf3

018 French Defense: Advance Variation, Nimzowitsch System

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. Nf3

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named C02 line

This section preserves all 22 names and defining routes assigned to C02 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

019 French Defense: Advance Variation, Paulsen Attack

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. c3 Nc6 5. Nf3

020 French Defense: Advance Variation, Ruisdonk Gambit

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. Nf3 cxd4 5. Bd3

021 French Defense: Advance Variation, Steinitz Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. dxc5

022 French Defense: Advance Variation, Wade Variation

1. e4 e6 2. d4 d5 3. e5 c5 4. c3 Qb6 5. Nf3 Bd7